

advantages that packaged apps provide, such as tight integration with the browser or the ability to download the entire app before ever running it.



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Hosted apps

- ▶ Hosted apps can usually work offline with the judicious use of Application Caching, an HTML5 technology.
- ▶ If your CRX file exceeds a size of 10 MB, a hosted app becomes a better choice.
- ▶ Use a hosted app if your existing web app uses server-side scripting to generate your pages and content, or if your app relies on form submissions and full page refreshes.
- ▶ Hosted apps will update automatically, just by updating your server.

Packaged apps

- ▶ Apart from ‘app’ behaviour, packaged apps also provide ‘extension’ behaviour. This can be exploited to improve the experience of your apps and differentiate from similar products.
- ▶ Because packaged apps are on the user’s local drive, they can launch immediately, without waiting for files from the web.
- ▶ Packaged apps can run in the background, even when the user has never launched your app.
- ▶ Apps that do not require a network connection, are ideal candidates for packaged apps because the user will be able to run them offline.

Additional info

If you are still not able to make up your mind, the following additional guidelines may do the trick for you: